

Oscar F. and Cletus Mitchell House
Proposed Champion Historic District
623-25 Gallagher St..
Springfield
Clark County
Ohio

HABS No. OH-2451

HABS
OHIO
12-SPRIF,
23-

PHOTOGRAPHS

WRITTEN HISTORICAL AND DESCRIPTIVE DATA

Historic American Buildings Survey
National Park Service
Great Lakes Systems Office
Department of the Interior
1709 Jackson St.
Omaha, Nebraska 68102

HISTORIC AMERICAN BUILDINGS SURVEY

OSCAR F. AND CLETUS MITCHELL HOUSE HABS No. OH-2451

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Location: 623-25 Gallagher Street, Springfield, Clark County, Ohio

Significance: This house is significant as an early example of vernacular duplex working class residential housing stock in the city. It retains its basic form although its front porch has been recently removed. The house contributes to the architectural character of the proposed Champion historic district as part of a row of nearly identical working class housing. The house is also notable for its pressed metal exterior, apparently original.

Description: The Mitchell House is a two-story rectangular frame building resting on a low stone foundation and featuring symmetrically arranged rectangular window and door openings. It is capped by a low-pitched hipped roof with a simple cornice. The exterior is sheathed in pressed metal panels stamped to simulate brick. Its cornice is also pressed metal. Doors at either end on the front elevation suggest that the house has always been a two-family residence, probably a duplex. The house is closely spaced beside similar neighboring buildings and has two windows on each side on the first floors and no windows on the second floor along the sides. Diagonal wood sheathing underneath peeled sections of the metal siding indicate that the metal was the original siding of this house. The house has a center corbeled brick chimney. There may at one time have been rear porches.

History: This building was probably constructed at the turn of the century, judging from its styling and materials. In 1915 this was listed as the residence of Oscar F. and Cletus Mitchell. Oscar Mitchell was vice president of the Peet & Schuster Co., sheet metal work. Perhaps that firm was responsible for its unusual sheet metal exterior. The other unit was listed as being vacant in 1915. Both units have had a variety of occupants over the years, mostly working class individuals. This building stands within a few blocks of the Champion Reaper factory, a major employer in Springfield at the turn of the century.

Sources: 1915 and later Springfield city directories. The building stands within the proposed Champion Historic District, which has been determined as an area potentially eligible for listing on the National Register of Historic Places by the Ohio State Historic Preservation Officer. Copies of information used to make this determination of eligibility for National Register status are at the Springfield Department of Planning and Development and the Ohio Historic Preservation Office.

Historian: Steven McQuillin, preservation consultant to the City of Springfield, 1997